



See changes in preferences without closing the Options menu

Every time you make layout changes in Firefox using Options, you must close the menu to observe the change and reopen it to make more changes. Wouldn't it be brilliant if you could preview the changes without closing the Options menu? Fortunately, Firefox has a hidden fix for this.

Open a new tab and type 'about:config'. Click on "I'll be careful, I promise". Once the config page is open, simply search for 'browser.preferences.instantApply' and change the pre-set value to 'true' by double-clicking to toggle.



Preview tabs the way Windows allows with ALT+TAB

[CTRL]+[TAB], by default, simply changes the active tabs on Firefox. It would be useful if that function could be modified to preview tabs in a similar way to what [ALT]+[TAB] does on recent Windows platforms. Fortunately, we can do just that. Open the about:config page and search for the preference name 'browser.ctrlTab.previews'. It's set to 'false' by default. Simply double-click to toggle the value to 'true' and you can preview tabs with [CTRL]+[TAB] after you restart Firefox.



Reduce restore delay

Sometimes, post minimising the browser, you experience a slight delay in the display of the webpage once the browser has been maximised again. This delay can be reduced. Go to the about:config page -> Right-click -> New -> Boolean. Name the boolean variable as 'config.trim_on_minimize' and set the value to 'false'. This prevents the delay and reduces RAM usage when Firefox is minimised.



Open search results in a new tab

When you search for a query in a search engine, the results open in the current tab and this can be annoying. To enable search results to open in a new tab in Firefox, simply set the preference name 'browser.search.openintab' to 'true'.



Select complete URL in the address bar (Linux) and autofill

When you click a URL in a browser in Windows or Mac, the entire URL gets selected. In Linux, however, you have the cursor sitting in the middle. It sounds like a small problem, but could actually get quite cumbersome at times. To select the entire URL with a click on Linux-based platforms, simply change the preference 'browser.urlbar.clickSelectsAll' to 'true'. To enable autofill for URLs in the Awesome Bar, set the 'browser.urlbar.autofill' preference to 'true'.



Reduce Menu Display delay

This tweak reduces the delay seen in the display of various browser menus. Create a new integer named 'ui.submenuDelay' and set it to '0'.



Disable interface animations to increase general speed

The UI of Firefox is built in such a way that there's a brief animation whenever a user opens, closes or switches a tab. Now, in principle this should have a negligible effect on the browser's performance, but switching off this animation does no harm visually and actually makes moving across tabs and reshuffling quicker. Set the preference 'browser.

tabs.animate' to 'false' in about:config.



Induce network-related tweaks for optimised browsing

You could perform some network-related tweaks to boost performance. Users on slower and faster connections might want to decrease and increase the value of 'network.http.max-connections' and 'network.http.max-connections-per-server', respectively. The latter set on a higher number allows the user to browse the site while downloading multiple contents from it. Low speed connection users could set 'network.http.pipelining' to 'true' for sending multiple requests before receiving a response from a site.



Render web pages more efficiently

To make pages render faster, create a new integer, name it 'nglayout.initialpaintdelay.delay' and then set it to '0'. This setting reduces the delay time between the initial rendering of a web page (that usually has light content) and the actual content that follows. Setting the delay to 0 will allow the

browser to render the page as soon as possible.

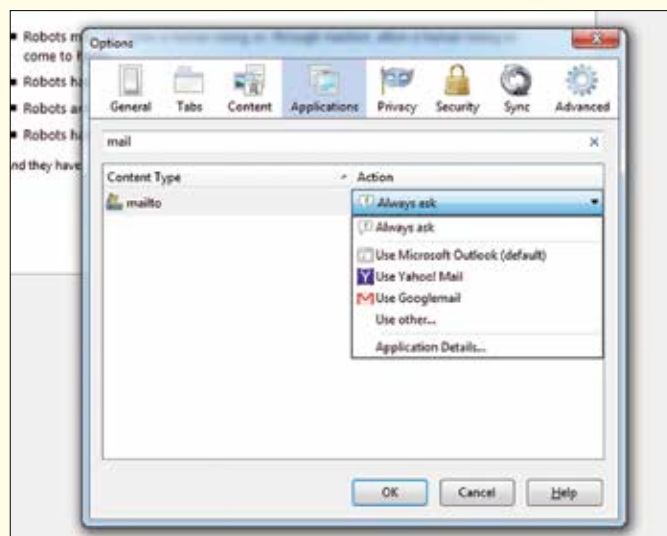


Increase offline cache size to work better offline

Users with limited internet access will find this tip helpful, as it allows them to continue working offline. Increase the offline cache value by changing the value of the preference 'browser.cache.offline.capacity'. The default value is 512000 (about 500 MB) but you can easily up it to a couple of GBs for your convenience.

MASTERING OUTLOOK

Love it or hate it Microsoft Outlook is one of the most popular email clients. It has nearly 16 percent of the market share just edging ahead of Gmail and trailing Apple's iOS clients. As an early enterprise productivity product Microsoft has ensured that Outlook is the de facto system on any PC desktop that runs Windows. So given the apparent ubiquitousness of the system it is very likely that everyone will come across it at some point or another, either in the office or at home. To ease this experience we present to you a handy assortment of shortcuts,



Change the default mail client like this